

Don't Affect Children – Moves the pivot without affecting the position of child objects in the hierarchy.

Reset Transform – Resets the transform to zero.

Reset Scale – Resets the scale of the object to 100 percent.

1.4.3 Snapping

The Object Snapping tools are good for snapping objects to precise positions. When you are moving objects, these tools let you snap objects to grids, other objects, or parts of other objects. Rotations can be snapped so the object rotates in specific increments.

Vertex – Snaps to a polygonal, mesh, or patch vertex

Pivot – Snaps to the pivot point of an object

Grid Points – Snaps to grid intersections

Endpoint – Snaps to the end points of edges on meshes or spline vertices

Midpoint – Snaps to the middle of edges on meshes and spline segments

Edge/Segment – Snaps to a polygonal or mesh edge or a spline segment

Face – Snaps anywhere on the surface of a face

Frozen – Snaps to frozen objects

Axis Constraints – Brings up the axis constraints toolbar, which limits motion along specified axes

1.5 Managing Objects

3ds Max has a number of tools that allow you to manage the display and behaviour of objects within the scene. Objects can be organized by type, colour, and name. Objects can also be hidden or frozen. This helps to organize scenes and eliminate clutter.

1.5.1 Hiding and Freezing Objects

3ds Max has the capability to hide objects from view, or to freeze them so that they can be viewed but not selected. If you're working with one set of objects, for example, you can hide or freeze other objects in the scene to make it easier to select and manipulate the desired objects. Selected objects can be hidden and/or frozen by using the quad menu or the Display panel.

1.5.2 Using Layers

Another way to manage objects is to separate them into layers by using the Layer Manager, which is accessed through the main toolbar. A layer is simply a collection of objects. Each layer has a unique name, and layers can be hidden or frozen. Layers can also be used for such tasks as rendering.